

Gary Hyde

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Dear Ashby hiring team,

I am applying for the Staff Product Engineer role, and I want to be direct about why it caught my attention: the way you describe the work is the way I already work. One TypeScript codebase, React on the frontend, Node.js, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, and Redis on the backend, with engineers owning projects from the schema to the UI. I have spent the last several years building products exactly that way, mostly on my own, because shipping as the whole team leaves no room for handoffs.

That end-to-end habit shows up across everything I have built. For TeeTimes, I designed the multi-tenant PostgreSQL data model, the Node.js booking engine, the background job pipeline on BullMQ and Redis, and the React frontend on top, all in one TypeScript stack. Kora took the same vertical approach for a direct booking engine, with Stripe and Stripe Tax scoped from day one. Pathara is an AI product I built end to end on the Claude API: the intake flow, the agent pipeline that does the research and writing, and the per-candidate results portal with downloads and an application tracker. In each case there was no separate design or backend resource. The schema being right before anything above it could be was my problem, and so was the UI that proved it.

The async-first, almost-no-meeting culture is a real draw, not a tolerance. I have worked independently and remotely for over ten years, and my default is to write the decision down. Specs, plans, and review notes are how I communicate, written to the standard a distributed team needs to act on them without a call. When a stock-overselling bug spanned both our WooCommerce and Odoo systems, I traced it to root cause and wrote up the incident as a document the team could actually use, not a verbal recap.

I read staff level here as technical leadership expressed through building rather than through meetings, and that is the part I am most excited about. I tend to lead by setting conventions and building the tooling that holds them. On my current team I built automated code review tooling that synthesizes multiple AI models into structured scorecards with Ship, Fix, and No-Ship verdicts, which raised our human-in-the-loop review bar, and I designed a Git commit convention (Mission Codes) to keep a multi-developer Odoo.sh workflow traceable. I also treat Claude Code and Cursor as genuine force multipliers, not autocomplete, which lets me design, build, and review far more in a day without dropping the documentation or quality standard.

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I would welcome the chance to show how I work in your codebase. Thank you for reading.

Sincerely, Gary Hyde